SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

12 September 2023 · Shift 3

46 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 44 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

General Awareness 21 questions

Q.2

The Sakraat festival is celebrated with the ‘Budigali’ or ‘Kalasi’ dance in _____, where women take part in this dance, carrying decorative pots on their heads.

(A) Odisha
(B) Nagaland
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Manipur

Q.3

The National Social Assistance Programme (NSAP) is a welfare programme being administered by which Ministry of Government of India?

(A) Ministry of Tribal Affairs
(B) Ministry of Home Affairs
(C) Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
(D) Ministry of Rural Development

Q.4

What is the main source of income for commercial banks?

(A) Donations from customers
(B) Profits from stock market investments
(C) Government grants
(D) Interest earned on loans and advances

Q.5

The Taj Mahal was built by:

(A) Humayun
(B) Jahangir
(C) Akbar
(D) Shah Jahan

Q.6

Who among the following made Ganesh Chaturthi popular as a public celebration in Maharashtra?

(A) Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(B) Khudiram Bose
(C) Vinayak Damodar Savarkar
(D) Lala Lajpat Rai

Q.7

Which country’s Constitution was the inspiration behind the Directive Principles of the Indian Constitution?

(A) The Constitution of Australia
(B) The Constitution of the United States
(C) The Constitution of the United Kingdom
(D) The Constitution of Ireland

Q.8

When one stone is thrown upwards, what type of energy conversion would occur?

(A) Kinetic energy would change to mechanical energy
(B) Potential energy would change to gravitational energy
(C) Mechanical energy would change to kinetic energy
(D) Kinetic energy would change to gravitational potential energy

Q.9

Lack of functional small intestine can cause a malabsorption disorder leading to diarrhoea, malnutrition, weight loss etc. This particular condition is known as:

(A) Down syndrome
(B) short bowel syndrome
(C) hypoglycaemia
(D) hyperglycaemia

Q.10

In December 2022, Government of India launched Grih Pravesh scheme. This scheme aims to provide benefits to the residents of ____ areas.

(A) only urban
(B) only rural
(C) only tribal
(D) both rural and urban

Q.11

Indian Industrialists reacted against colonial policies that restricted business activities and formed an organisation in 1927. What was it called?

(A) Indian Industrial and Commercial Congress(IICC)
(B) Organization of Industries of India (OII)
(C) Federation of the Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industries (FICCI)
(D) Confederation of Indian Industries (CII)

Q.12

Who founded the All-India Forward Bloc Party?

(A) Chandra Shekar Azad
(B) Bhagat Singh
(C) Rasbehari Bose
(D) Subhas Chandra Bose

Q.13

The Constitution allows _____ maximum members in Lok Sabha as of June 2023.

(A) 546
(B) 550
(C) 545
(D) 543

Q.14

Which of the following novels is based on the partition of India and was written by Khushwant Singh?

(A) The Great Indian Novel
(B) Untouchables
(C) Narcopolis
(D) Train to Pakistan

Q.15

Which institution mainly provides financial assistance and support to microfinance institutions in India?

(A) Department of Economic Affairs (DEA)
(B) Ministry of Corporate Affairs
(C) Indian Banks' Association (IBA)
(D) Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)

Q.16
Mango showers are associated with which two states?

(A) Kerala and Karnataka
(B) Uttar Pradesh and Bihar
(C) Kerala and Andhra Pradesh
(D) Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka

Q.19
Lachhu Maharaj is a celebrated _____ dancer.

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Bharatnatyam
(C) Odissi
(D) Kathak

Q.20
What is the name of the mascot for the 37th National Games?

(A) Jelly
(B) Pandi
(C) Olly
(D) Moga

Q.22
Manika Batra won bronze medal in Asian Cup tournament. She is related to which sport?

(A) Judo
(B) Chess
(C) Table Tennis
(D) Gymnastic

Q.23
What is the name of the geographic feature that serves as a boundary between India and Sri Lanka?

(A) Strait of Gibraltar
(B) Dardanelles Strait
(C) Bosporus Strait
(D) Palk Strait

Q.24
FIFA U-17 Women's World Cup 2022 final was held in which city?

(A) Margo
(B) Navi Mumbai
(C) Bhubaneswar
(D) Ahmedabad

Q.25
The Tata Iron and Steel Company Limited (TISCO) was started in the year _____ at Sakchi in Jharkhand state.

(A) 1989
(B) 1907
(C) 1951
(D) 1975

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1
The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. By the time I turn thirty / I would had visited every / continent in the world and have gained / a wealth of knowledge and experience.

(A) By the time I turn thirty
(B) a wealth of knowledge and experience
(C) I would had visited every
(D) continent in the world and have gained

Q.2
The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) It is a / (B) state of chaos / (C) since the / (D) chairman resigned.

(A) D
(B) A
(C) B
(D) C

Q.3
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. The apple of one's eye

(A) Very cheerful
(B) Very dear
(C) Very nice
(D) Very pleasing

Q.4
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Harmony

(A) Adaptability
(B) Clarity
(C) Unity
(D) Conflict

Q.5
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Pandemics have often been caused by a disease that "spreads by physical touch or contact."

(A) are contagious
(B) are vigorous
(C) are robust
(D) are fastidious

Q.6
Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. The two neighbours will probably stop fighting "when pigs fly"

(A) When their families meet
(B) When there is magic
(C) Something that is impossible
(D) When it rains

Q.7
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Her dedication to her work was _____ what anyone had expected.

(A) over
(B) beyond
(C) beside
(D) through

Q.8
There is a spelling error in the given sentence. Select the option that contains the INCORRECTLY spelt word. He was in despare because of the expiry of his licence.

(A) expiry
(B) because
(C) licence
(D) despare

Q.9
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Demolish

(A) Invite
(B) Criticise
(C) Construct
(D) Appreciate

Q.10
Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Tushar is junior than all his colleagues.

(A) junior than all
(B) is
(C) Tushar
(D) his colleagues

Q.11
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Enchanted

(A) Disgusted
(B) Cursed
(C) Appealing
(D) Repelling

Q.12

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. By the skin of your teeth

(A) By a very narrow margin
(B) To be less affected by criticisms and rebuffs
(C) Very protective
(D) Saved by others

Q.13

The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) One of / (B) my brothers write / (C) novels for / (D) leisure.

(A) D
(B) A
(C) B
(D) C

Q.14

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Henry is known / as an excellent writer / and good communicator / in English.

(A) as an excellent writer
(B) in English
(C) Henry is known
(D) and good communicator

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The arrangement of events or dates in the order of their occurrence

(A) Chronology
(B) Theology
(C) Entomology
(D) Psychology

Q.16

Choose the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. As soon as Rohan learned that he had topped the examination, he was “on cloud nine”.

(A) Very tense
(B) Very sad
(C) Very happy
(D) Very confused

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the following sentence. His research on the migratory patterns of the birds is “run-of-the-mill.”

(A) absurd
(B) one in a million
(C) trash
(D) average

Q.18

Select the option that rectifies the spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence. The politician “guaranted” that he would create jobs if elected.

(A) gurranted
(B) gauaranteed
(C) guarranteed
(D) guaranteed

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The old man distributed his property _____ his ten grandchildren equally.

(A) within
(B) among
(C) towards
(D) between

Q.20

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Paraphernalia
(B) Handkerchiefs
(C) Conjuror
(D) Indispensible

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Medical hand practices have been an integral part of healthcare for centuries, but with technological advancements, machines are (1)_____ taking over. Robotic surgeries, for instance, have become increasingly popular, allowing surgeons to perform complex (2)_____ with minimal invasive techniques. Machine learning and artificial intelligence have transformed medical diagnosis by analysing large amounts of patient data and providing highly detailed medical images. However, there are still challenges to overcome in the use of these technologies in healthcare. For example, the cost of purchasing and maintaining medical machines can be high, and there are concerns around the ethical use of AI in medicine. Nonetheless, it is clear that medical hand practices are (3)_____ to machines, and these developments have the potential to revolutionise the healthcare industry. Additionally, the use of telemedicine and remote monitoring devices allows patients to receive medical care from the (4)_____ of their homes, particularly beneficial for those in rural or remote areas. Furthermore, medical machines provide healthcare professionals with real-time information, (5) _____ them to make informed decisions and adjust treatment plans accordingly.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) sincerely
(B) partially
(C) gradually
(D) deliberately

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Medical hand practices have been an integral part of healthcare for centuries, but with technological advancements, machines are (1)_____ taking over. Robotic surgeries, for instance, have become increasingly popular, allowing surgeons to perform complex (2)_____ with minimal invasive techniques. Machine learning and artificial intelligence have transformed medical diagnosis by analysing large amounts of patient data and providing highly detailed medical images. However, there are still challenges to overcome in the use of these technologies in healthcare. For example, the cost of purchasing and maintaining medical machines can be high, and there are concerns around the ethical use of AI in medicine. Nonetheless, it is clear that medical hand practices are (3)_____ to machines, and these developments have the potential to revolutionise the healthcare industry. Additionally, the use of telemedicine and remote monitoring devices allows patients to receive medical care from the (4)_____ of their homes, particularly beneficial for those in rural or remote areas. Furthermore, medical machines provide healthcare professionals with real-time information, (5) _____ them to make informed decisions and adjust treatment plans accordingly.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) therapies
(B) diagnosis
(C) analysis
(D) procedures

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Medical hand practices have been an integral part of healthcare for centuries, but with technological advancements, machines are (1)_____ taking over. Robotic surgeries, for instance, have become increasingly popular, allowing surgeons to perform complex (2)_____ with minimal invasive techniques. Machine learning and artificial intelligence have transformed medical diagnosis by analysing large amounts of patient data and providing highly detailed medical images. However, there are still challenges to overcome in the use of these technologies in healthcare. For example, the cost of purchasing and maintaining medical machines can be high, and there are concerns around the ethical use of AI in medicine. Nonetheless, it is clear that medical hand practices are (3)_____ to machines, and these developments have the potential to revolutionise the healthcare industry. Additionally, the use of telemedicine and remote monitoring devices allows patients to receive medical care from the (4)_____ of their homes, particularly beneficial for those in rural or remote areas. Furthermore, medical machines provide healthcare professionals with real-time information, (5) _____ them to make informed decisions and adjust treatment plans accordingly.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) diminishing
(B) evolving
(C) depleting
(D) stagnating

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Medical hand practices have been an integral part of healthcare for centuries, but with technological advancements, machines are (1)_____ taking over. Robotic surgeries, for instance, have become increasingly popular, allowing surgeons to perform complex (2)_____ with minimal invasive techniques. Machine learning and artificial intelligence have transformed medical diagnosis by analysing large amounts of patient data and providing highly detailed medical images. However, there are still challenges to overcome in the use of these technologies in healthcare. For example, the cost of purchasing and maintaining medical machines can be high, and there are concerns around the ethical use of AI in medicine. Nonetheless, it is clear that medical hand practices are (3)_____ to machines, and these developments have the potential to revolutionise the healthcare industry. Additionally, the use of telemedicine and remote monitoring devices allows patients to receive medical care from the (4)_____ of their homes, particularly beneficial for those in rural or remote areas. Furthermore, medical machines provide healthcare professionals with real-time information, (5) _____ them to make informed decisions and adjust treatment plans accordingly.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) locality
(B) comfort
(C) range
(D) inconvenience

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Medical hand practices have been an integral part of healthcare for centuries, but with technological advancements, machines are (1)_____ taking over. Robotic surgeries, for instance, have become increasingly popular, allowing surgeons to perform complex (2)_____ with minimal invasive techniques. Machine learning and artificial intelligence have transformed medical diagnosis by analysing large amounts of patient data and providing highly detailed medical images. However, there are still challenges to overcome in the use of these technologies in healthcare. For example, the cost of purchasing and maintaining medical machines can be high, and there are concerns around the ethical use of AI in medicine. Nonetheless, it is clear that medical hand practices are (3)_____ to machines, and these developments have the potential to revolutionise the healthcare industry. Additionally, the use of telemedicine and remote monitoring devices allows patients to receive medical care from the (4)_____ of their homes, particularly beneficial for those in rural or remote areas. Furthermore, medical machines provide healthcare professionals with real-time information, (5) _____ them to make informed decisions and adjust treatment plans accordingly.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) reimagining
(B) adapting
(C) neglecting
(D) enabling

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(D)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**
Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**			

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.2 · Answer (A) Odisha

A Government of India list of tribal dances (PIB, January 2023) gives Budigali, also called Kalasi, as a dance of the Santhal tribe of Odisha, performed at the Sakraat festival.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Ministry of Rural Development

The National Social Assistance Programme, launched on 15 August 1995, pays old-age, widow and disability pensions and other social assistance to poor households, and is run by the Ministry of Rural Development.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Interest earned on loans and advances

Banks earn mainly the interest on the loans and advances they make, which is more than the interest they pay on deposits.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Shah Jahan

The Mughal emperor Shah Jahan built the Taj Mahal at Agra as a tomb for his wife Mumtaz Mahal. Humayun, Akbar and Jahangir reigned before him.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak

Bal Gangadhar Tilak turned Ganesh Chaturthi into a public festival in 1893, to bring people together against British rule.

Q.7 · Answer (D) The Constitution of Ireland

The Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV) were borrowed from the Irish Constitution of 1937.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Kinetic energy would change to gravitational potential energy

As the stone rises it slows down: its kinetic energy is changed into gravitational potential energy, which is greatest at the top of its path.

Q.9 · Answer (B) short bowel syndrome

Short bowel syndrome results when much of the small intestine is missing or does not work, so nutrients are poorly absorbed. Down syndrome is a chromosomal condition, and hypo- and hyperglycaemia mean low and high blood sugar.

Q.10 · Answer (D) both rural and urban

The Grih Pravesh programme, which the Prime Minister launched at Agartala, Tripura, in December 2022, covered over two lakh beneficiaries of the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana, Urban as well as Rural.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Federation of the Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industries (FICCI)

The Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI) was founded in 1927, with G. D. Birla and Purshottamdas Thakurdas among its founders.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Subhas Chandra Bose

Subhas Chandra Bose formed the All India Forward Bloc in 1939, after he resigned as Congress president.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 550

Article 81 allows up to 530 members from the states and 20 from the Union territories: 550. The two seats for nominated Anglo-Indians (Article 331) lapsed in January 2020 under the 104th Amendment.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Train to Pakistan

Khushwant Singh's 'Train to Pakistan' (1956) is set in a Punjab border village at Partition. 'The Great Indian Novel' is Shashi Tharoor's and 'Narcopolis' Jeet Thayil's.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)

SIDBI, the principal financial institution for micro, small and medium enterprises, lends to microfinance institutions for on-lending to small borrowers and supports the sector's development.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Kerala and Karnataka
Pre-monsoon showers in Kerala and coastal Karnataka are called mango showers because they help mangoes ripen early.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Kathak
Lachhu Maharaj, of the Lucknow gharana and brother of Achchan and Shambhu Maharaj, was a Kathak dancer who also choreographed dances for Hindi films. (The Banaras tabla player Pandit Lachhu Maharaj is a different person.)

Q.20 · Answer (D) Moga
Moga, an Indian bison (gaur), was unveiled in June 2023 as the mascot of the 37th National Games, held in Goa in October and November 2023; the name comes from the Konkani word for love.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Table Tennis
Manika Batra is a table tennis player; her bronze at the 2022 Asian Cup in Bangkok was the first medal won by an Indian woman at the event.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Palk Strait
The Palk Strait separates Tamil Nadu from northern Sri Lanka. The Strait of Gibraltar lies between Spain and Morocco, and the Dardanelles and the Bosporus are in Turkey.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Navi Mumbai
The final of the 2022 FIFA U-17 Women's World Cup, held in India, was played at the DY Patil Stadium in Navi Mumbai on 30 October 2022; Spain beat Colombia 1-0.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 1907
TISCO was registered in 1907 and built its works at Sakchi, the village that grew into Jamshedpur (renamed in 1919).

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) I would had visited every
A modal takes the base form 'have', and 'by the time I turn thirty' looks ahead, so the future perfect is needed: 'I will have visited every continent'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) A
With 'since' and a point in time the present perfect is needed: 'It has been a state of chaos since the chairman resigned.'

Q.3 · Answer (B) Very dear
'The apple of one's eye' is the person one loves and cherishes most: very dear.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Conflict
'Harmony' is agreement and peace; its opposite is 'conflict'. 'Unity' is close in meaning to it.

Q.5 · Answer (A) are contagious
SSC's key gives 'are contagious': a contagious disease is one that spreads by direct contact. (With the singular 'a disease' the verb would be 'is'; every option begins with 'are'.)

Q.6 · Answer (C) Something that is impossible
'When pigs fly' means never: something that is impossible.

Q.7 · Answer (B) beyond
'Beyond' means further than or exceeding: her dedication went beyond what anyone had expected.

Q.8 · Answer (D) despare
The correct spelling is 'despair'. ('Licence' is the British spelling of the noun.)

Q.9 · Answer (C) Construct
To 'demolish' is to pull down; its opposite is 'construct'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) junior than all
'Junior', like 'senior', 'superior' and 'inferior', takes 'to', not 'than': 'Tushar is junior to all his colleagues.'

Q.11 · Answer (C) Appealing
SSC's key gives 'appealing': 'enchanted' means charmed or delighted, and 'appealing' (attractive, charming) is the nearest option, though strictly it matches 'enchanting'. 'Disgusted' and 'repelling' are nearly opposites, and 'cursed' (doomed, under an evil spell) carries a sense of harm that 'enchanted' does not.

Q.12 · Answer (A) By a very narrow margin
'By the skin of one's teeth' means only just, by a very narrow margin.

Q.13 · Answer (C) B
After 'one of' the subject is 'one', so the verb is singular: 'One of my brothers writes novels for leisure.'

Q.14 · Answer (D) and good communicator
SSC's key gives 'and good communicator': the second noun has its own adjective, and the 'an' before 'excellent' does not suit 'good', so it takes its own article: 'an excellent writer and a good communicator'. (One article before two nouns that describe the same person is also met, so the sentence as printed is not plainly wrong.)

Q.15 · Answer (A) Chronology
'Chronology' is the arrangement of events in the order in which they happened. Theology is the study of religion, entomology of insects and psychology of the mind.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Very happy
To be 'on cloud nine' is to be extremely happy.

Q.17 · Answer (D) average
'Run-of-the-mill' means ordinary, not special: 'average'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) guaranteed
The correct spelling is 'guaranteed'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) among
'Among' is used for more than two people, 'between' for two: 'among his ten grandchildren'.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Indispensible
The correct spelling is 'indispensable'. 'Conjuror' is an accepted spelling of 'conjurer'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) gradually
'Gradually' (step by step) fits machines taking over as technology advances; the others do not describe a change over time.

Q.22 · Answer (D) procedures
The sentence is about robotic surgery: surgeons perform complex 'procedures', that is, operations. Diagnosis and analysis are not operations, and therapies are given rather than performed by surgeons.

Q.23 · Answer (B) evolving
To 'evolve to' is to change gradually into something: hand practices are moving over to machines, in line with the developments the passage describes. 'Stagnating' contradicts that change, and 'diminishing' and 'depleting' (shrinking, being used up) do not fit 'to machines'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) comfort
'From the comfort of their homes' is the set phrase for doing something without leaving home.

Q.25 · Answer (D) enabling
Real-time information is 'enabling' them, making them able, to make informed decisions.

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